Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically on Monday, January 20, 2025

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 1:01 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the minutes of the Regular Meeting of Council held on December 9, 2024 be adopted.

CARRIED

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the minutes of the Special Meeting of Council held on December 13, 2024 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier invited questions on agenda items from those present.

Douglas Glass, Ajax resident, asked questions regarding agenda item 3.2 Adoption of Minutes – December 13, 2024 (item 4.3). Mayor Collier and Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Mr. Glass.

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.1 Delegation: Income, Employment and Homelessness Supports Division in the Social Services Department Updates

Lisa McIntosh, Director, Income, Employment & Homelessness Supports, Social Services Department, The Regional Municipality of Durham and Sahar Foroutani, Manager, Homelessness Service System, Income, Employment & Homelessness Supports, Social Services Department, The Regional Municipality of Durham, provided an update on Durham Region's Homelessness System. Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. L. McIntosh responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked L. McIntosh and S. Foroutani for their

delegation.

5.2 Presentation: 2024 Ajax Partnership Fund Final Report and 2025 Ajax Partnership Fund Projects

Liam Nichols, Grants & Strategic Initiatives Coordinator, delivered a presentation related to the 2024 Ajax Partnership Fund Final Report and 2025 Ajax Partnership Fund Projects. Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. L. Nichols and Kassandra Brownridge, Manager of Strategic Initiatives, responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked L. Nichols for their presentation.

5.3 Delegation: Ajax Anti-Racism Task Force Update

Yasmyn Belle, Diversity, Equity & Inclusion Officer, introduced Chantelle Vernon, Co-Chair, Ajax Anti-Racism Task Force. C. Vernon provided updates from the Ajax Anti-Racism Task Force. Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. Y. Belle and Mary Lou Cosentino, Manager, HR Services, responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked C. Vernon for their presentation.

Council recessed at 2:54 p.m.

Council resumed at 3:00 p.m.

6. Correspondence

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the report dated January 20, 2025 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1. Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

7.1.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee, January 6, 2025

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated January 6, 2025 be adopted.

CARRIED

7.2. General Government Committee Report

7.2.1 General Government Committee, January 13, 2025

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the General Government Committee Report dated January 13, 2025, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities Report dated January 20, 2025, as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

7.4 **Departmental Reports**

None.

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillor Members provided updates from the Region related to the Durham-Scarborough Bus Rapid Transit project and changes to Committee composition. Council Members asked questions related to the reports. Regional Councillor Crawford responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of January 20, 2025 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 **Motion to Implement a Short-Term Rental Framework in Ajax**

Mayor Collier and Councillor Henry introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: N. Henry

WHEREAS Canada is facing a housing crisis and a rise of short-term rental (STR) properties can have an impact on the availability of long-term rental housing options;

AND WHEREAS the Town of Ajax is a committed and recognized leading partner in Canada and Ontario's efforts to defeat the housing crisis;

AND WHEREAS the federal government has introduced the Short-Term Rental Enforcement Fund to ensure that STR operators are given clear rules which balance the needs of the broader community and the realities of the sharing economy;

AND WHEREAS Town of Ajax staff are undertaking a comprehensive review of the existing Ajax Zoning By-law 95-2003 in order to update zoning permissions and standards to align with the Ajax Official Plan;

AND WHEREAS on October 21, 2024, as part of the Comprehensive Zoning By-Law Review, Ajax Council directed staff to define a STR in the Final Zoning By-Law Amendment(s), that STRs be defined, and that staff update the definition of a Bed and Breakfast Establishment to make clear the separation in uses, with an overview of the changes brought forward for consideration at a future meeting of the Community Affairs and Planning Committee;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Planning and Development permit short-term rentals in all urban residential zones, where appropriate, through the Comprehensive Zoning By-Law Review;

2. Corporate Services work with short-term rental platforms to receive data related to short-term rentals in Ajax, establish a condition that all short-term rental operators in Ajax are operating out of their principal residence, and coordinate with rental platforms in relation to issues of nuisance and enforcement;

3. Public and Strategic Affairs, with support from appropriate departments, be directed to:

    a. apply to the Short-Term Rental Enforcement Fund;

    b. launch an education campaign to highlight short-term rental best practices to operators; and

c. provide an update to Council on the status of the implementation of short-term rental framework by the end of September 2025.

CARRIED

9.2 **Meeting Education Needs in New Density Projects**

Regional Councillor Crawford and Regional Councillor Dies introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: J. Dies

WHEREAS as urban municipalities in Ontario approve more high-rise developments, the educational needs of children living in these developments requires consideration.

AND WHEREAS Ajax has a fixed urban boundary and many of the new development proposals being received by the Town are for multi-story, high density projects.

AND WHEREAS projects proposed by developers in Ajax over the past year may see as many as 3,727 dwelling units on a single site.

AND WHEREAS primary and secondary schools could be included in the podiums of high-rise buildings, providing easy access to children within the development and in the surrounding built-up area.

AND WHEREAS it is important that consideration for a new school in the podium of a tower be contemplated in the early stages of design and approval.

AND WHEREAS through the Provincial Planning Statement, the Province encourages planning authorities in collaboration with school boards to encourage innovative approaches in the design of schools and childcare facilities.

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Ajax Council calls on the provincial government to require developers to work closely with local school boards in the early stages of developments with high density to assess education needs and where applicable, include schools in the design of the podium;

2. Ajax Council calls on local school boards, including the Durham District School Board, Durham Catholic District School Board, Conseil Scolaire Viamonde and MonAvenir Conseil Scolaire Catholique, work with the municipalities and developers to consider innovative approaches to education; and

3. A copy of this resolution be forwarded to Premier Doug Ford, the Ontario Minister of Education, MPP for Ajax Patrice Barns, and the Ontario Big City Mayors.

CARRIED

9.3 **Motion Requesting the Redistribution of the Provincial Land Transfer Tax and GST to Municipalities for Sustainable Infrastructure Funding**

Councillor Tyler Morin and Regional Councillor Crawford introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

WHEREAS municipalities face growing infrastructure needs, including roads, bridges, public transit, water systems, and other critical services, which are essential to community well-being and economic development;

AND WHEREAS the current sources of municipal revenue, including property taxes and user fees, are insufficient to meet these increasing demands for infrastructure investment;

AND WHEREAS the Province of Ontario currently collects the Land Transfer Tax (LTT) on property transactions in municipalities across the province, generating significant revenue that is not directly shared with municipalities;

AND WHEREAS the Federal Government collects the Goods and Services Tax (GST) on property transactions, a portion of which could be directed to municipalities to address local infrastructure needs;

AND WHEREAS redistributing a portion of the LTT and GST to municipalities would provide a predictable and sustainable source of funding for local infrastructure projects without creating a new tax burden on residents or homebuyers;

AND WHEREAS a redistribution of a portion of the existing LTT and GST would allow municipalities to better plan and invest in long-term infrastructure initiatives, supporting local economic growth and improving the quality of life for residents;

AND WHEREAS on November 27, 2024, Durham Regional Council passed a resolution requesting the Federal and Provincial governments redistribute a portion of the LTT and GST to municipalities;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Ajax Council calls on the Provincial Government to consider redistributing a portion of the Land Transfer Tax collected on property transactions to municipalities and remind the province that it has been asked by AMO and municipalities to develop a new and comprehensive funding arrangement with municipalities, including the housing affordability taskforce recommendations;

2. Ajax Council calls on the Federal Government to allocate a percentage of the Goods and Services Tax collected on property sales to municipalities;

3. Redistribution of the LTT and GST should be structured to provide predictable and sustainable funding to municipalities, allowing for better long-term planning and investment in infrastructure projects that benefit local communities, thus ensuring that local governments receive a fair share of the revenue to address critical infrastructure needs;

4. A copy of this resolution be forwarded to Prime Minister Justin Trudeau, Premier Doug Ford, the Ontario Minister of Finance, the Minister of Municipal Affairs and Housing, local Members of Parliament (MPs), Members of Provincial Parliament (MPPs), all 444 Municipalities in Ontario, the Federation of Canadian Municipalities (FCM), and the Association of Municipalities of Ontario (AMO) for their endorsement and advocacy.

CARRIED

10. By-laws

Council Members asked questions related to By-law 06-2025, Election Sign By-law. Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer and Mayor Collier, responded questions from Council Members.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-law numbers 01-2025 to 09-2025 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

None.

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming community events and matters of community interest.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: L. Bower

Seconded by: S. Lee

That By-law number 10-2025 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its regular meeting held on January 20, 2025, be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the January 20, 2025 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (3:29 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor and CEO

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Clerk